



ANNUAL REPORT



CITIZENSHIP BY INVESTMENT
SAINT LUCIA

CIP Saint Lucia

Annual Report 2022-2023

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CIP Saint Lucia

Citizenship by Investment Board

Board of Directors



CHAIRMAN'S FOREWORD



Governing Principles

As the overseer of the Citizenship by Investment Programme (CIP) in Saint Lucia, I am proud to say that our operations have consistently upheld the core governing principles of integrity, efficiency, accountability and transparency.

Our Board, composed of five seasoned professionals, remains fully committed to fulfilling our mandate to the government and people of Saint Lucia. Sixty-percent of Board members have been accredited through the Director Education and Accreditation Programme Charter governance institute of Canada (CGIC) demonstrating our dedication to serving our country with the utmost respect and diligence.

Integrity

Integrity lies at the core of all Citizenship by Investment Programs, shaping the ethical foundation and credibility of these initiatives. As the demand for second citizenship through investment continues to rise, the need for upholding integrity within investment migration programs becomes increasingly paramount.

In the early months of 2022, the investment migration industry faced significant challenges in processing applications for individuals from Russia, Belarus and Iran. Due to the political unrest in these regions, the Citizenship by Investment Unit was unable to conduct proper due diligence and accept funds from applicants within these jurisdictions. As a result, Saint Lucia made the decision in February 2023 to suspend receipt of applications from the above noted countries.

Additionally, the Citizenship by Investment Unit experienced significant delays in processing bank fees due to limitations with its two banking partners. This led to significant delays in the processing of citizenship applications and agent license applications during the reporting period. A testament to the enhancement and successes of the marketing efforts initiated in the previous reporting period of 2021/2022.

As the demand for second citizenship through investment continues to rise, and challenges within the industry persist, the imperative of upholding integrity within the investment migration industry becomes increasingly paramount.



CHAIRMAN'S FOREWORD

Efficiency

One of the key drivers of success in the investment migration industry is the efficiency of application processing times to which Saint Lucia programme was negatively impacted. To address these challenges, the Citizenship by Investment Unit implemented creative and innovative solutions to streamline internal processes. This included setting and achieving targets by departments, improving the marketing of its pre-processing module, and establishing strategic partnerships with key due diligence stakeholders such as the Joint Regional Communication Center (JRCC), the Royal Saint Lucia Police Force (RSLPF), and reputable third-party Due Diligence firms.

As a result of these efforts, the average processing times for citizenship applications during the reporting period of 2022/2023 decreased by an impressive 65% compared to the previous reporting period of 2021/2022. Applications with up to two dependents were processed within 35 business days, while applications with more than two dependents were processed within 63 business days. This significant improvement in processing times not only demonstrates the Citizenship by Investment Unit's commitment to efficiency and excellence but also enhances the overall experience for applicants seeking citizenship through investment.

We are steadfast in our commitment to effectively manage our Citizenship by Investment Programme. We recognize the dynamic nature of the investment migration market and, therefore, the Board has dedicated itself to actively promoting our investment migration product in various key jurisdictions, including the United States of America, Europe, the Middle East, and Africa. Our efforts extend beyond promoting our investment migration product to also enhancing the reputation of Brand Saint Lucia.

The Programme has been significantly improved with the introduction of the VIBE initiative, which urges citizens granted through the programme to Visit, Invest, Build, and Establish themselves in Saint Lucia. This initiative aims to eliminate the transaction barriers that have traditionally existed within the investment migration industry, transforming it into a platform for partnership and growth.

As part of the enhancements to the Citizenship by Investment Programme, a new investment option has been launched under the Government Bond Option. This option eliminates the temporary and non-viable products that were previously offered. One of the new investment options is the National Action Bond, which has been available for investment starting from 1 January 2023. This non-interest-bearing bond has a minimum investment amount of US \$300,000.

These improvements to the Programme not only streamline the investment process but also provide more sustainable and attractive options for potential investors. Saint Lucia is committed to fostering a conducive environment for investment and growth, and these enhancements are a testament to that commitment.



Chairperson, Citizenship by Investment Board

CHAIRMAN'S FOREWORD

Accountability

Accountability in investment migration programs refers to the responsibility of governments and stakeholders to ensure transparency, integrity, and adherence to regulations under such programs.

The Citizenship by Investment Programme was a crucial component of the evaluation process conducted by the Caribbean Financial Action Task Force (CFATF) in relation to anti-money laundering measures. Despite not being a reporting entity, the Citizenship by Investment Unit (CIP Saint Lucia) has actively engaged and participated in the CFATF monitoring and evaluation process for the past five years.

Accountability mechanisms such as due diligence checks on applicants, third-party audits of investments, and reporting requirements are essential to maintaining the credibility and legitimacy of our programs and we continue to work closely with key stakeholders in the management such.

As a Board, we have recognized the need for various changes to enhance efficiency and customer service within the investment migration industry, while ensuring the integrity and security of our citizenship by investment programme remains uncompromised. The launch of the VIBE on 1 January 2023, marked a significant milestone, accompanied by legislative changes introduced through the Citizenship by Investment (Amendment) (No. 2) Regulations.

These changes include the implementation of a background and due diligence fee of US \$7,500 for assessments on all developers seeking approval for CIP Real Estate or Enterprise Projects. Additionally, a new Government Bond option has been established with the introduction of a National Action Bond requiring a minimum investment of US \$300,000.

Furthermore, the threshold for Real Estate Investments has been reduced from US \$300,000 to US \$200,000. Moreover, individuals granted citizenship through the CIP have had the opportunity to include dependents by submitting an application and meeting the required investment criteria through the program. In response to this, the Board has increased the investment amount for newborns (0-12 months) from US \$500 to US \$5,000.

We understand that accountability is crucial for maintaining trust in investment migration programs and protecting the interests of both investors and our Saint Lucia.

Transparency

The promotion of citizenship through investment is a strategic marketing approach designed to attract high-net-worth individuals interested in obtaining citizenship by making a significant financial contribution to a country. This practice involves utilizing the benefits of investment migration programs to appeal to potential investors seeking to enhance their global mobility and access new opportunities.

During the reporting period of 2022/2023, the Board initiated efforts to establish strategic partnerships with key global marketing partners; CS Global Partners (6 June 2022), Arton Capital (10 June 2022), Latitude Consultancy Limited (20 October 2022) and Bluemina Citizenship & Residency Inc (12 January 2023). These partners have played a crucial role in the strategic marketing and promotion of our investment migration product and further Brand Saint Lucia by helping to enhance our outreach and attract more potential investors and visitors alike.



Chairperson, Citizenship by Investment Board

CHAIRMAN'S FOREWORD

Despite facing numerous challenges, our Saint Lucia program achieved significant success thanks to the dedicated team of professionals at the Citizenship by Investment Unit. In the 2022/2023 reporting period, we saw an impressive 85% increase in citizenship applications compared to the previous year, with a total of one-thousand and seventy-six (1,076) citizenship applications received. However, during the period, five-hundred and forty-four (544) were granted citizenship, while eight (8) applications were denied.

This reporting period saw a 12% increase in gross revenue generated through the Citizenship by Investment Programme, totaling EC \$60,631,316 in addition to the following remitted to the Government and People of Saint Lucia as per the various investment categories namely, the National Economic Fund (NEF) totaling EC \$41,371,397 and the Covid-19 Government Bonds totaling EC \$42,295,519. These achievements demonstrate the effectiveness and efficiency of our program, and we look forward to continuing to serve our clients and contribute to the growth and development of our Saint Lucia.

Closing

As a Board, we are excited to continue collaborating with our key stakeholders to enhance Saint Lucia in 2023 and beyond. We have successfully transformed the Citizenship by Investment Unit and Programme from its humble beginnings to its current status as a leading provider of second citizenship and a welcoming home for individuals. We are committed to further improving our services and offerings to ensure that Saint Lucia remains a top choice for those seeking a second citizenship.



Lorne Theophilus
Chairperson
Citizenship by Investment Board

Citizenship by Investment Board of Directors

Board Governance



Due Respect & Diligence

The Board, composed of no more than five (5) members appointed by the Cabinet of Saint Lucia, plays a crucial role in overseeing the Citizenship by Investment Programme.

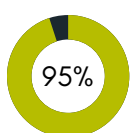
The Board consists of a Chairperson – Mr. Lorne Theophilus, Deputy-Chairperson, Mr. Julian Charles, Directors Mr. Sean Alexander, Mr. Rene Williams and Mr. Efreem Edgar who were all appointed to the Board on 1 September, 2021.

Sadly, Mr. Edgar who fell ill passed away on 24 May, 2022 resulting in the vacancy of one Director position on 24 May, 2022. He was later replaced by Ms. Isa Cyril, an Attorney-at-Law and Crown Counsel IV from the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions who was appointed as Director on 1 December, 2022. Ms. Cyril served on the Board for a period of three(3) months before departing on 8 March 2023.

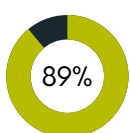
The Board is responsible for efficiently coordinating, administering, and overseeing the operations of the Citizenship by Investment Unit. This includes reviewing and making decisions on applications for citizenship by investment in Saint Lucia, establishing the functions and duties of the Citizenship by Investment Unit, and issuing guidelines to ensure the proper functioning of the Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Programme.

The Board further provides recommendations to the Minister with responsibility for the citizenship by investment programme on the development and enhancement of its investment migration product.

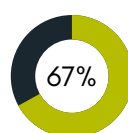
Therefore, the Board must convene regularly to oversee the efficient management of the Citizenship by Investment Programme and to make determinations regarding the approval or denial of citizenship applications and agent licensing.



Lorne Theophilus
Chairperson



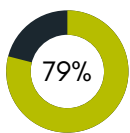
Julian Charles
Deputy –Chairperson



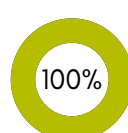
Effrem Edgar
Director (deceased)



Sean Alexander
Director



Rene Williams
Director



Isa Cyril
Director

Citizenship by Investment Board of Directors
Honoring the life of a great man

In Loving Memory of



Effrem O. Edgar

Sunset- 24 May 2022



Mr. Effrem O. Edgar was a seasoned Attorney-at-Law with over twenty-five years experience, having been admitted to the Bar of England & Wales and Saint Lucia in 1995. He held a Bachelor's Degree with Honors in Law (with a minor in Accounting), a Master of Laws Degree in Commercial and Corporate Law from the London School of Economics and Political Science (University of London), as well as a Diploma in Business Administration and an Advanced Diploma in Marketing Management.

A respected figure in his community of Choiseul and Saint Lucia at large, Mr. Edgar also served as a dedicated Director of the Citizenship by Investment Programme (CIP) in Saint Lucia.

His sharp wit, engaging personality, honesty, sharpness, diligence, and unwavering dedication were evident at every Board meeting he attended from September 2021 until his last virtual appearance on 28 April, 2022.

Known for being the "life of the party" at the Citizenship by Investment Unit, Director Edgar is deeply missed.

Though his time with us was brief, Director Edgar's fond memories and words of encouragement have continued to inspire us at CIP Saint Lucia. May his soul rest in eternal peace.

CIP Saint Lucia

Citizenship by Investment Unit

The Operations



Chief Executive Officer, Citizenship by Investment Unit CEOs Remarks

As the famous saying goes, the only constant in life is “change”, and perhaps no industry embodies this more than the investment migration sector. The Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Programme has experienced significant uplift in interest and applications with the latter growing by 85% relative to the previous fiscal year 2021/2022.

The just concluded period has seen the doubling of marketing agents, with the addition of experienced and respected brands from the industry; increased visibility from emerging territories in the Middle East and Northern Africa and consistent efforts made to improve our already robust due diligence processes.

To further strengthen our operations, we have increased our human capital to ensure a more streamlined application and effective due diligence process. We have also collaborated with industry-leading firms to align our training and development with the evolving geo-political landscape and human trends, both positive and negative.



These changes have been implemented with a clear focus on maintaining the integrity of Saint Lucia's strong brand. In our industry, precision is paramount, and we are guided by our "Beyond the Passport" mantra.

We view our Saint Lucian citizenship as more than just a means for visa-free travel. Infact, we reject such narrow thinking! For us, Saint Lucia represents a hub of investment opportunities, lifestyle experiences, romantic encounters, and an overall positive atmosphere. Becoming a Saint Lucian entails a commitment to enhancing these value propositions and contributing to the growth of our brand, Saint Lucia.

I must acknowledge the dedicated team at the Citizenship by Investment Unit, who are the driving force behind our operations. In an industry that demands more than a standard eight-hour workday, these professionals exemplify patriotism and go above and beyond to ensure the success of the Citizenship by Investment Programme and, by extension, Saint Lucia.

In the coming year we will build on the successes of 2022/2023 as we look forward to a further expansion in our reach and interest. These developments, we expect will solidify our position as a leader in the investment migration sector and serve to improve the quality of life for our citizens.

Mc Claude Emmanuel
Chief Executive Officer
Citizenship by Investment Unit

Citizenship by Investment Unit

Functions of the Citizenship by Investment Unit

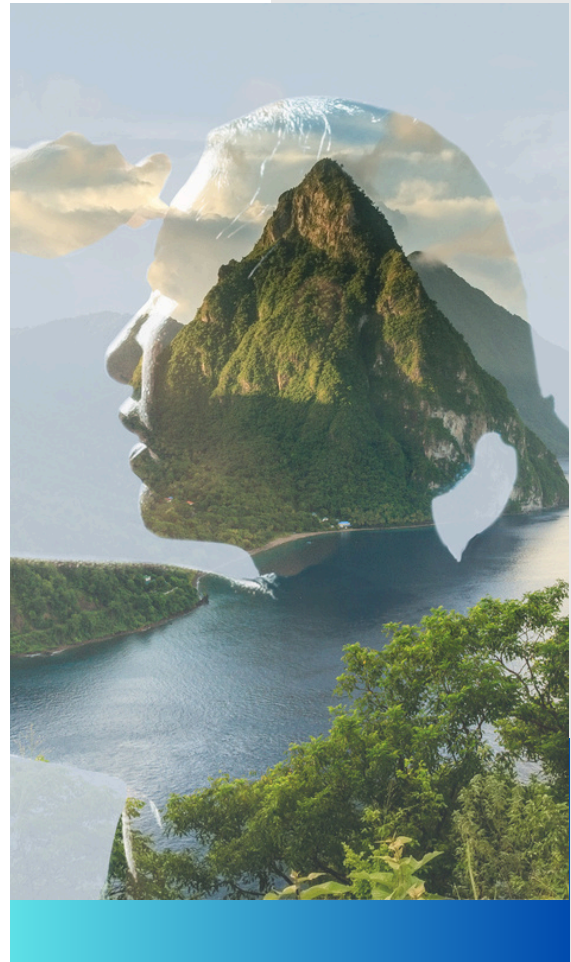
The Citizenship by Investment Board appointed Mr. Mc Claude Emmanuel as the Chief Executive Officer.

Mr. Emmanuel is hereby responsible for the overall management of the affairs of the Citizenship by Investment Unit and the Alien Landholding Licensing Department comprising a then fifteen (15) member staff body which has grown by 00%^[1] within the reporting fiscal period 2022/2023.

The appointed leader of the Unit is tasked with providing essential guidance and direction. Mr. Emmanuel oversees the Citizenship by Investment Programme to ensure its independence and integrity aligns with international best practices.

Additionally, he is responsible for managing all aspects of the Citizenship by Investment Unit and Alien Landholding Licensing Department's operations.

There are four (4) ways by which one may apply to become a citizen of Saint Lucia through the Citizenship by Investment Programme (CIP).



Our Investment Portfolio



National Economic Fund

Investment starting at US \$100,000



Government Bonds

Investment starting at US \$300,000



Real Estate Project

Investment starting at US \$200,000



Enterprise Project

Investment starting at US \$3,500,000

Citizenship by Investment Unit

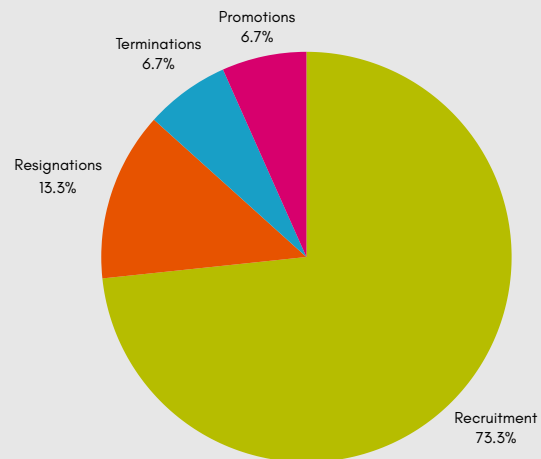
Human Capital

Mastering the Craft

The success of the Citizenship by Investment Programme is largely attributed to the dedication and expertise of its staff body.

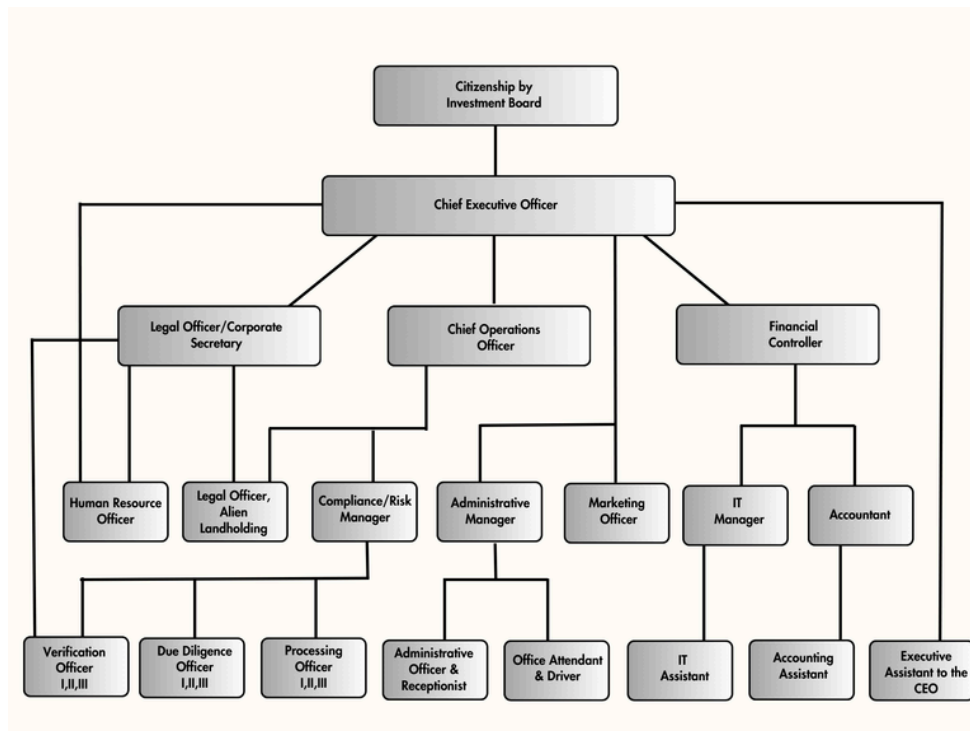
All employees undergo continuous training in various areas such as due diligence and compliance in addition to Investment Migration (IMC) related Trainings and Certifications.

This ensures that they are all well-equipped to effectively manage the Citizenship by Investment Programme and provide exceptional service to our stakeholders.



Human Resource Capacity

As a result of a substantial increase in the number of application files received during the reporting period, the Unit strategically bolstered its human capital in core processing areas by increasing onboarding by 40% compared to the previous period enhancing the Due Diligence, Verification/Compliance, and Accounts Departments.



Citizenship by Investment Unit

Marketing Campaigns & Initiatives

Our Philosophy - Beyond the Passport

The Citizenship by Investment Programme has evolved to focus on providing citizens with opportunities that go beyond simply obtaining a passport. This shift is exemplified by the launch of the campaign "Beyond the Passport." We warmly welcome our global citizens to explore the myriad possibilities for vacationing, investing, building, and establishing themselves in Saint Lucia.

In recent years, there has been a growing concern among citizens about how funds generated from citizenship by investment programs are utilized. Various recommendations have been proposed to ensure a more transparent process in identifying the tangible benefits of offering citizenship in exchange for an approved investment.

The COVID-19 pandemic has had a devastating impact on the tourism industry, leading to closed airports and travel restrictions. This has highlighted the importance of citizenship programs in attracting foreign direct investment. It is now more crucial than ever for us, as global citizens, to acknowledge our role in sustaining our world through our actions.

CIP Saint Lucia, in collaboration with the Government and people of Saint Lucia, extended a heartfelt invitation to all global citizens who have acquired citizenship through the investment programme. We encourage all citizens to Visit/Vacation, Invest, Build, and Establish themselves on our beautiful island through the VIBE initiative.

It is our belief that Saint Lucia offers much more as a destination than just the convenience of visa-free travel. The establishment of opportunities for all citizens, beyond the advantages of holding a passport, underscores the value of citizenship through investment programs and their tangible impact on the populace.



VACATION

Saint Lucia is renowned for its stunning natural beauty and the hospitality of its people. The island boasts international and domestic airports that welcome daily flights from the USA, Canada, Europe, and the wider region. Saint Lucia invites its citizens to embark on a journey of discovery that will leave a lasting impression. Come to Saint Lucia and let the island inspire you!

INVEST

Saint Lucia is renowned for its diverse investment opportunities, spanning from tourism and agro-processing to renewable energy, global business outsourcing, and smart manufacturing. Saint Lucia welcomes investors with open arms. Seize the opportunity to make your mark in this thriving economy!

BUILD

Situated below the hurricane belt, Saint Lucia is a sought-after retirement destination renowned for its understated elegance and lively atmosphere. The island's blend of English and French influences gives it a distinct creole charm, complemented by efficient shipping and air freight services, a robust telecommunications industry, a thriving financial sector, and top-tier education and healthcare facilities. Saint Lucia eagerly awaits your arrival to make it your new home.

ESTABLISH

Individuals granted citizenship through our program possess a wealth of wisdom and knowledge. By sharing their expertise through education, training, and philanthropic efforts, we can greatly benefit from the development of our people. Let us collaborate to pave the way towards a prosperous future for Saint Lucia.

Our aim is to steer our country and its people towards a path of prosperity and success.

Citizenship by Investment Unit Marketing Activations & Highlights

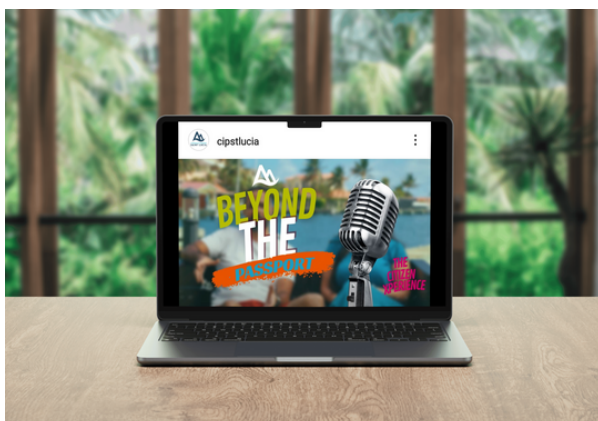
The Citizen Xperience

The Citizenship by Investment Programme hosted a group of individuals who were granted citizenship through the programme. These citizens had the privilege of visiting the island during the vibrant carnival season in July 2022. This unique experience, known as the Citizen Xperience, was designed to immerse the visitors in the rich culture of Saint Lucia.

The primary objective of the Citizen Xperience was to provide a lasting impact on the visiting citizens, and this goal was undeniably achieved. Throughout their visit, the citizens had the opportunity to witness traditional dances, partake in joyful celebrations, and truly experience the essence of island life. Some even chose to renew their marriage vows, while children delighted in the simple pleasures that Saint Lucia has to offer.

In addition to cultural immersion, the visiting citizens were also able to explore potential investment opportunities on the island. This included the option to establish vacation and retirement homes, showcasing the potential for long-term growth and prosperity.

Overall, the Citizen Xperience proved to be a memorable and enriching opportunity for all involved. Not only did it highlight the beauty of Saint Lucian culture, but it also emphasized the island's potential for investment and development.



Influencer Marketing

The Citizenship Programme had the honor of hosting Mohamed (@rahalista) in January 2023 on the picturesque island of Saint Lucia. Mohamed is a well-known influencer and content creator who shares captivating stories from around the world.

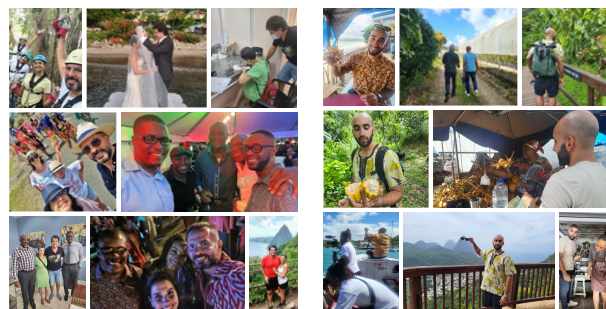
With an impressive 3.5 million followers across Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube, Rahalista's audience comes from various Arab countries, particularly Saudi Arabia and Libya which are important markets for investment migration.

Recently appointed as a Young Goodwill Ambassador by the European Union, Mohamed also achieved the second spot in the prestigious Content Creator Competition in the Middle East and North African Region – Sadeem's Season 1.

His main objective is to inspire individuals to pursue their passions, no matter how unconventional they may seem. What better place to continue his journey than his homeland.

Rahalista beautifully captured the essence of authentic Saint Lucia, garnering over 1 million views on YouTube and more than 50,000 impressions on Instagram. His itinerary included visits to the Castries Market, Howelton Estate, Morne Fortune Tour, Gros Islet Friday Night Street Party, The Cocoa Tour at Hotel Chocolat, and Tet Paul Nature Trail, among others.

Among his most cherished moments were leisurely walks and playing dominoes with the elders in Gros Islet. He also found peace in visiting the Castries Mosque during prayer hours. Born in Libya, Mohamed now holds Saint Lucian values close to his heart.



Citizenship by Investment Unit

Citizenship Application Platform & IT Advancement

This fiscal year 2022/2023 has marked a significant milestone in the advancement of our technological infrastructure, showcasing our unwavering dedication to excellence and innovation.

One of the most notable achievements during this period has been the extensive enhancement of our internal network infrastructure. For the first time in the history of our Unit, we have made substantial investments in upgrading our network components, resulting in a more contemporary and resilient technology framework that is poised to meet the demands of our operations for the next 7-10 years.

This upgraded infrastructure not only offers a plethora of modern features but also delivers exceptional speed, efficiency, and security, perfectly aligning with the ever-evolving IT landscape of today.

In addition to infrastructure improvements, the IT Department has experienced significant growth in its user base. We have expanded our IT support from serving seventeen (17) users to efficiently meeting the needs of twenty-six (26) users. This expansion involved the provisioning of new laptops, monitors, printers, and other peripherals to our staff, along with their configuration and maintenance.

This expansion underscores our commitment to providing seamless IT support to meet the evolving demands of our organization as technology becomes increasingly integral across various departments. Looking ahead, our focus is on the development and planning of an upgraded Citizenship by Investment Portal Version 2 and the Alien Landholding Portal. These initiatives are built on a new programming architecture to enhance efficiency, increase capacity, improve speed, introduce new features, and bolster security for our Citizenship Unit's operations. This modernized foundation will enable the seamless integration of advanced features, ensuring adaptability to future requirements.

In addition to software enhancements, we have procured critical IT infrastructure equipment. These acquisitions are essential in strengthening our overall IT framework, ensuring reliability, and mitigating potential disruptions.

Looking forward, the future of the IT Department involves completing these upgrades and maintaining a focus on leveraging technology to enhance and streamline our citizenship application processes. By embracing these advancements, we will position ourselves at the forefront of technological innovation, promoting efficiency, and upholding the high standards that define Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Programme.



Citizenship by Investment Unit

The Citizenship Application Process

'a due diligence perspective'

In the realm of investment migration, the concept of acquiring citizenship through investment has gained significant traction. However, it is imperative to approach this avenue with a thorough due diligence perspective to ensure the legitimacy and credibility of the process.

Investing in citizenship requires a meticulous examination of the legal framework, financial transparency, and reputation of the country offering such programs. By conducting a comprehensive due diligence process, countries can mitigate risks and make informed decisions.

In today's global landscape, citizenship by investment has become a popular option for individuals seeking to expand their opportunities and secure their future. Nevertheless, it is crucial to approach this avenue with caution and prudence, ensuring that all aspects of the process are thoroughly vetted and verified.



The Investment Migration or Citizenship-by-Investment Industry operates under the fundamental principles of transparency, efficiency, and due diligence. The Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Unit employs a comprehensive and rigorous approach to due diligence.

Before accepting a citizenship application, our partner agents meticulously screen applicants using KYC (know your client) protocols and other online database systems to ensure they meet the requirements of the Saint Lucia Citizenship Programme.

Furthermore, throughout the verification and vetting process of citizenship applications, the Citizenship by Investment Unit collaborates closely with local law enforcement, regional intelligence partners, and reputable international firms.

By adopting a "due diligence first perspective", countries may navigate the complexities of citizenship by investment programs and safeguard their interests. This approach not only enhances the credibility of the investment process but also ensures a secure and legitimate pathway to acquiring citizenship through investment.

Due diligence remains a cornerstone principle in the operations of our Citizenship by Investment Programme ensuring the integrity and credibility of the process.



CIP Saint Lucia

Citizenship by Investment Applications Received, Granted & Denied

7-Year Review: 1 April **2016** – 31 March **2023**



Citizenship Applications Received, Granted & Denied

7 Year Review: 2016 - 2023

RECEIVED

85%



increase from previous reporting period

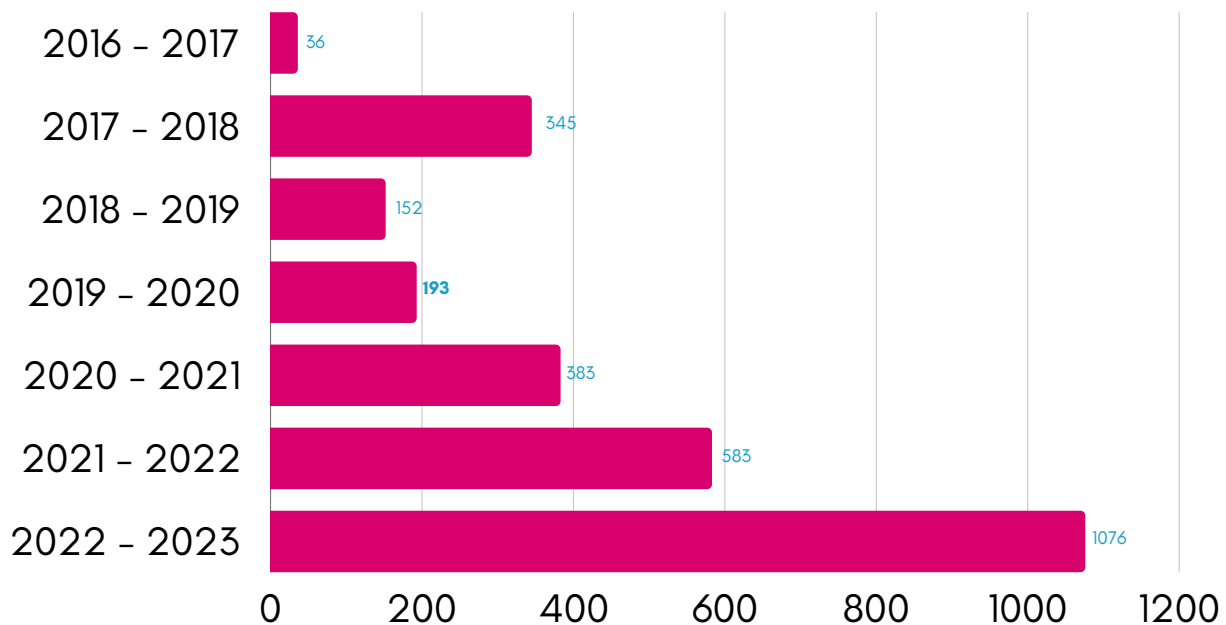
Please be advised that the fiscal year of the Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Programme spans from 1 April to 31 March

The bar graph presented below illustrates the number of Citizenship Applications Received from the year 2016 to 2023.

The Citizenship by Investment Programme has seen a consistent growth in the volume of citizenship applications over the past seven years. This increase can be attributed to the program's extensive global marketing campaigns, as well as its reputation for being a reliable and trustworthy option within the investment migration community.

All citizenship applications must be submitted through an Authorized Agent who is annually licensed by the Citizenship by Investment Board.

These Agents play a crucial role in screening applications before they are submitted to the Unit. It is imperative that Authorized Agents maintain a physical business presence in Saint Lucia and demonstrate a genuine commitment to the country's best interests.



Citizenship Applications Received, Granted & Denied

7 Year Report: 2016 - 2023

GRANTED

**90 – 120
days**

legislated processing time

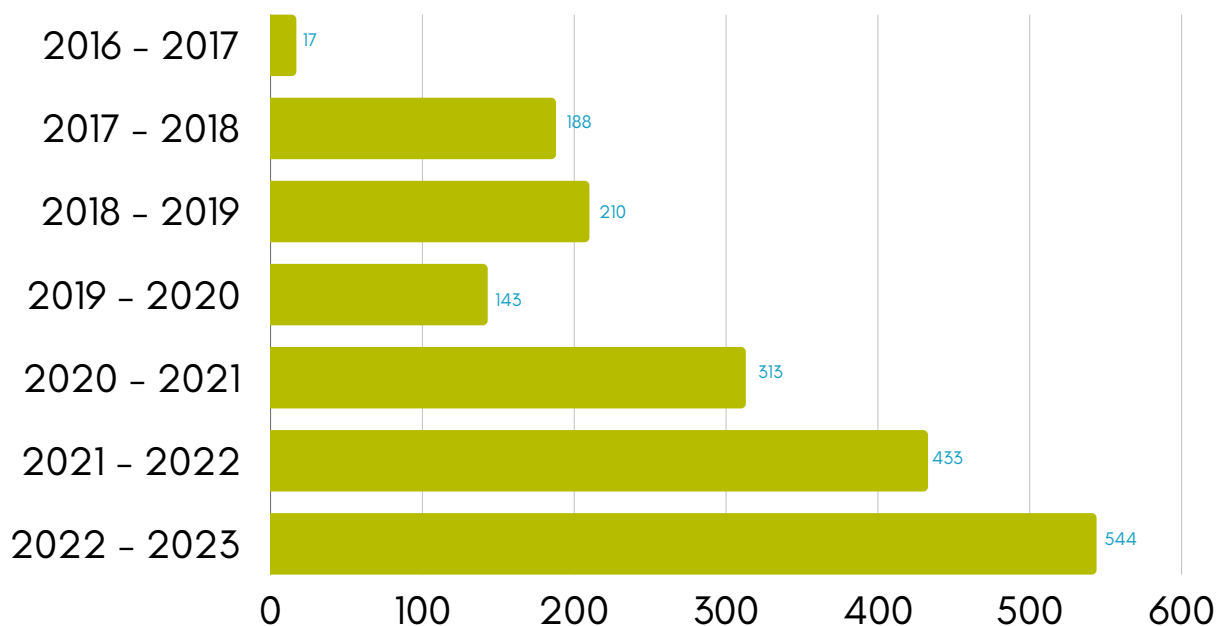
Please be advised that the fiscal year of the Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Programme spans from 1 April to 31 March

The bar graph provided below illustrates the number of Citizenship Applications Granted from the year 2016 to the end of the reporting period in 2023.

It is absolutely imperative that the Chief Executive Officer present a comprehensive Due Diligence (DD) Finding Report and Recommendation to the Citizenship by Investment Board for each applicant seeking citizenship. The Board then deliberates on the DD Findings, which assess the character and suitability of the applicants for Saint Lucia citizenship.

While the Board has the authority to grant citizenship, applicants are required to fulfill all post citizenship approval obligations to receive a Certificate of Registration (CoR), also known as a Citizenship Certificate.

It is worth noting that applications submitted in one reporting period may be carried over to the next reporting period for consideration or decision based on the date of submission as processing times are between 90-120 days or may extend further as all applications are reviewed on a case-by-case basis.



Citizenship Applications Received, Granted & Denied

7 Year Report: 2016 - 2023

DENIED

1.5%

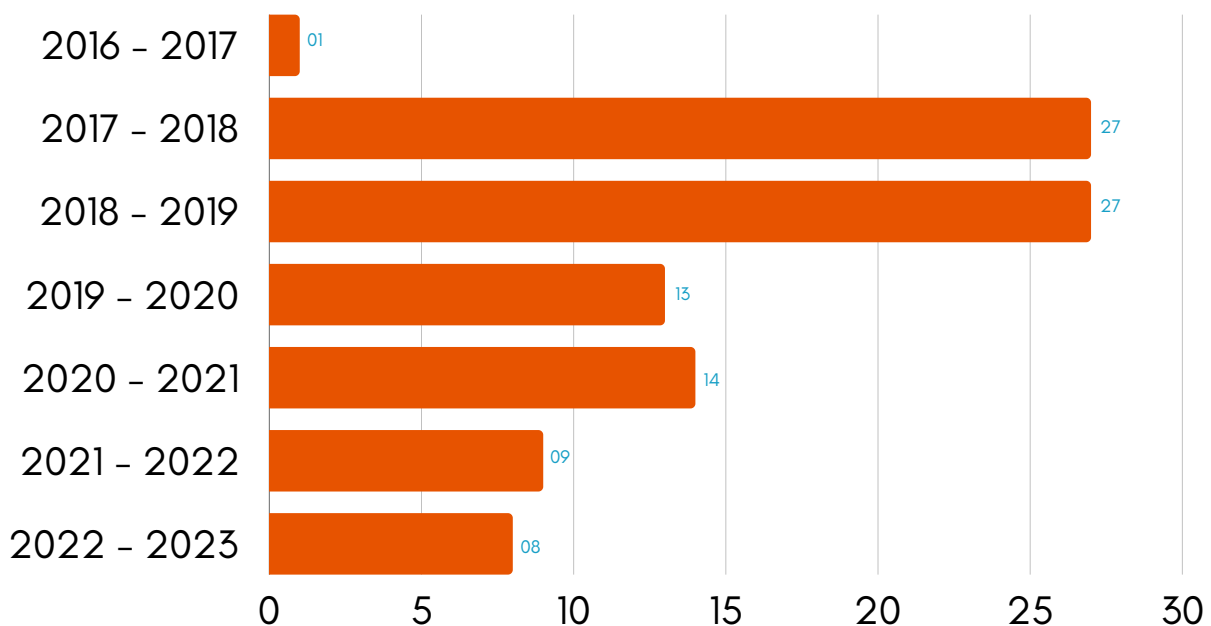
Rate of Denial

Please be advised that the fiscal year of the Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Programme spans from 1 April to 31 March

The bar graph presented below illustrates the number of Citizenship Applications Denied from the year 2016 to the end of the reporting period in 2023. The Citizenship by Investment Programme is governed by the primary legislation known as the Citizenship by Investment Act No. 14 of 2015, which delineates the reasons for denial of citizenship applications. Individuals who do not meet the criteria outlined in this Act may not be granted or approved citizenship.

An applicant who -

- provides false information;
- has been convicted of a criminal offence except where the offence is a minor traffic offence;
- is the subject of a criminal investigation;
- is considered to be a potential national security risk;
- is involved in any activity likely to cause disrepute to Saint Lucia;
- has been denied a visa to a country with which Saint Lucia has visa-free travel and has not subsequently obtained a visa to that country.



CIP Saint Lucia

Citizenship by Investment Applications Received, Granted & Denied

Fiscal Period: 1 April **2022** to 31 March **2023**



Review of Citizenship Applications for the Reporting Fiscal Year **2022 - 2023** 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023

During the period 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023, the Citizenship by Investment Programme (CIP Saint Lucia) approved/granted a total of five-hundred and forty-four (544) citizenship applications.

Out of these, four-hundred and forty-four (444) have successfully completed the post- approval citizenship cycle and, have been issued a Certificate of Registration (CoR) also known as Citizenship Certificates.

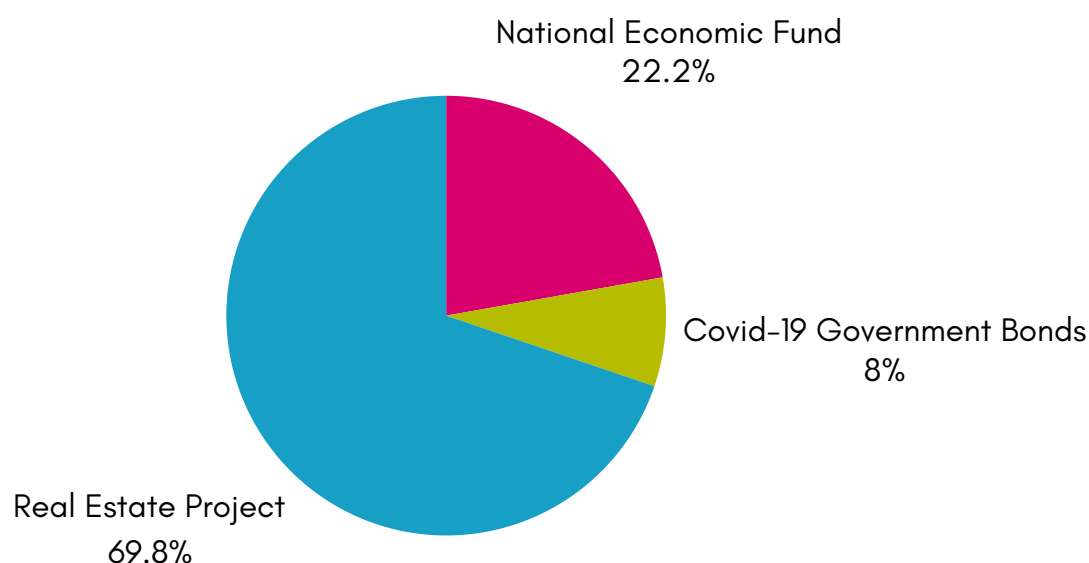
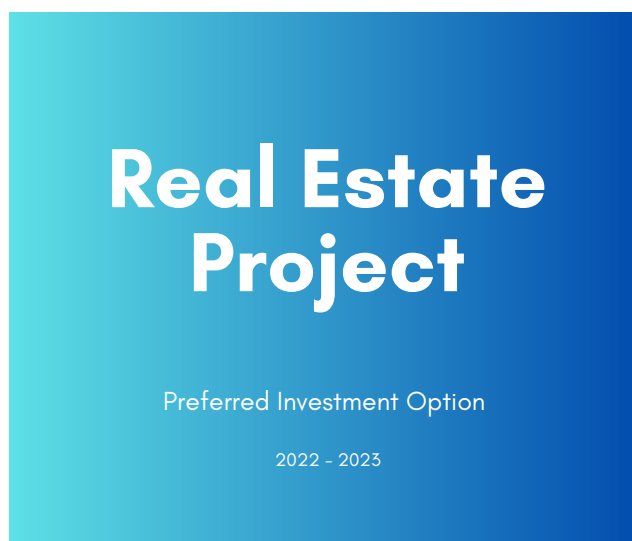
The Citizenship by Investment Programme offers individuals the opportunity to obtain citizenship of Saint Lucia through investment in one of four qualifying options.

During the reporting period, only three options were available for investment namely; the National Economic Fund, Government Bonds and, one (1) Real Estate Project open for investment.

The chart below illustrates the preferred investment option for individuals submitting applications for citizenship during the period 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023.

Of the one-thousand and seventy-six (1,076) applications received, according to the data, 69.8% of applicants choose to apply for citizenship through the Real Estate Option, while 22.2% and 8% opted for the National Economic Fund and Government Bond options, respectively.

This information provides insight into the investment preferences of individuals seeking citizenship in Saint Lucia during the specified period.



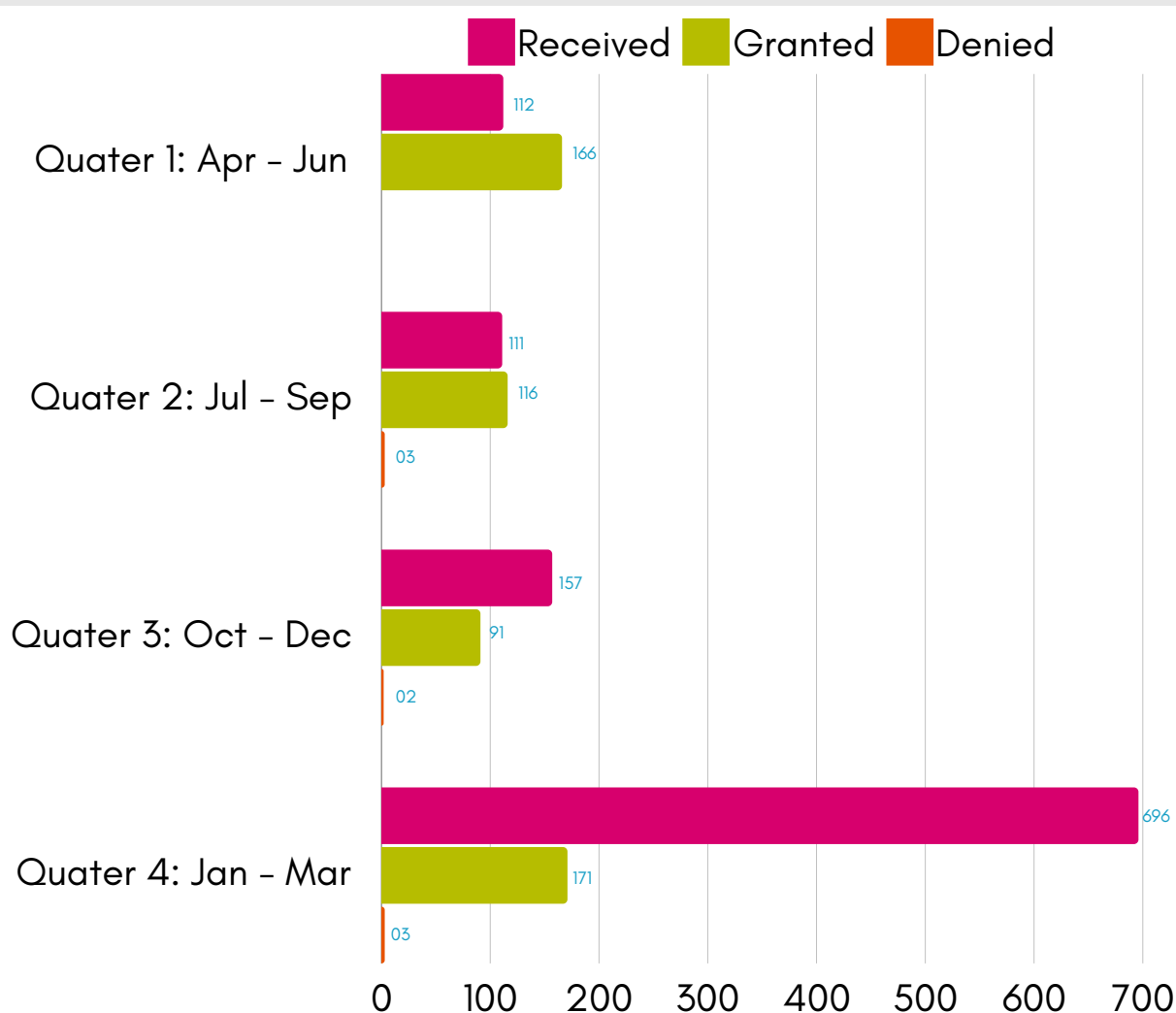
Review of Citizenship Applications for the Reporting Fiscal Year **2022 - 2023** 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023

Of the citizenship applications received during this reporting period and as previously depicted, a total of 33.8% of decisions have been rendered by the Citizenship by Investment Board. To which, a decision was made to grant or deny the applicant seeking economic citizenship.

Majority of those applications to which decisions have been rendered, were processed through the National Economic Fund as the preferred investment option.

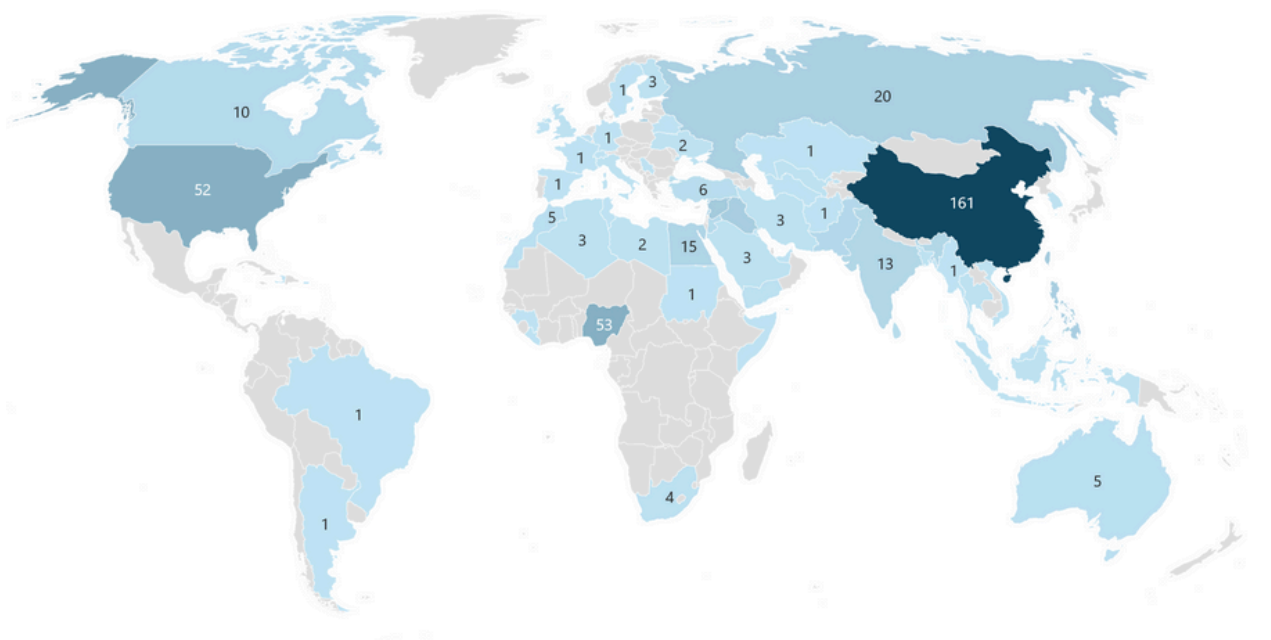
The graph below further illustrates the number of citizenship applications received vs. granted vs. denied per quarter for the reporting period.

Quarter 1(April 23' - June 23'); Quarter 2(July 23' - September 23'); Quarter 3(October 23' - December 23'); Quarter 4(January 24' - March 24').



Review of Citizenship Applications for the Reporting Fiscal Year 2022 - 2023

1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023



The map displays the countries of origin for all individuals who have been granted citizenship in Saint Lucia during the reporting period of 2022/2023.

This data offers valuable insight into the diverse backgrounds of individuals who have become citizens of Saint Lucia.

The breakdown below reflects the regions by country of birth of individuals seeking economic citizenship in Saint Lucia during the period 2022/2023.



01 Asia



02 Rest of the World

encompassing North, Central, and South America, as well as Europe



03 Africa



04 Middle East



05 Russian Federation

Investment Contribution

Government Bonds, National Economic Fund & Real Estate Project

Fiscal Period: 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023



Investment Contribution for the Reporting Fiscal Period

2022 - 2023

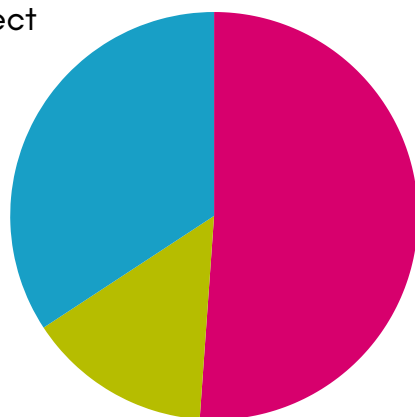
1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023



Overall total investments received for the period 2022/2023 equates to EC\$107,692,200 with contributions made namely to the National Economic Fund and Covid-19 Government Bond Option to which the breakdown of which is reflected in the audited financial statement for the period.

The pie chart depicts the distribution of decisions made for each investment option during the current reporting period, with the National Economic Fund taking the lead by accounting for over half of the decisions made and funds accounted for, during this reporting period.

Real Estate Project
34.2%



National Economic Fund
51.1%

Covid-19 Government Bonds
14.6%

Investment Contribution for the Reporting Fiscal Period

2022 - 2023

1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023



GOVERNMENT BONDS

Inflows generated from the Government Bond options are directed to the Government of Saint Lucia, overseen by the Ministry of Finance, which manages all government bond processing and execution. The Citizenship by Investment Unit retains the administrative fee to sustain its operations.

01

COVID-19 Bond Relief Option

In the face of the global socio-economic challenges brought on by the Covid-19 pandemic, countries around the world have been forced to prioritize innovation in order to drive their economies forward and Saint Lucia is no exception to this trend.

Recognizing the need for practical modernization and a thorough understanding of the requirements of potential investors, these two factors were crucial in the launch and issuance of the zero-coupon Covid-19 Bond Relief Option under the Saint Lucia Citizenship by Investment Programme in 2020. This initiative was effective from May 2020 to December 2020.

Due to its success and positive impact, the Bond was extended for an additional 2-year period, covering 1 January 2021 to 31 December 2021 and 1 January 2022 to 31 December 2022 respectively. This extension demonstrated Saint Lucia's commitment to stimulating economic growth and attracting investment during such challenging times.

Investment Contribution for the Reporting Fiscal Period

2022 - 2023

1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023

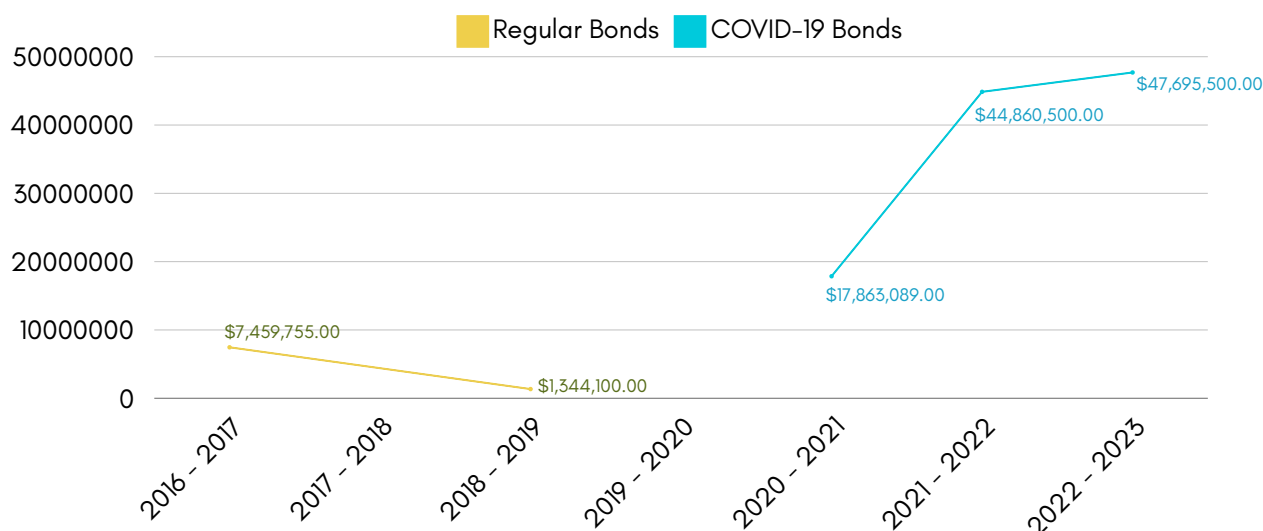


02

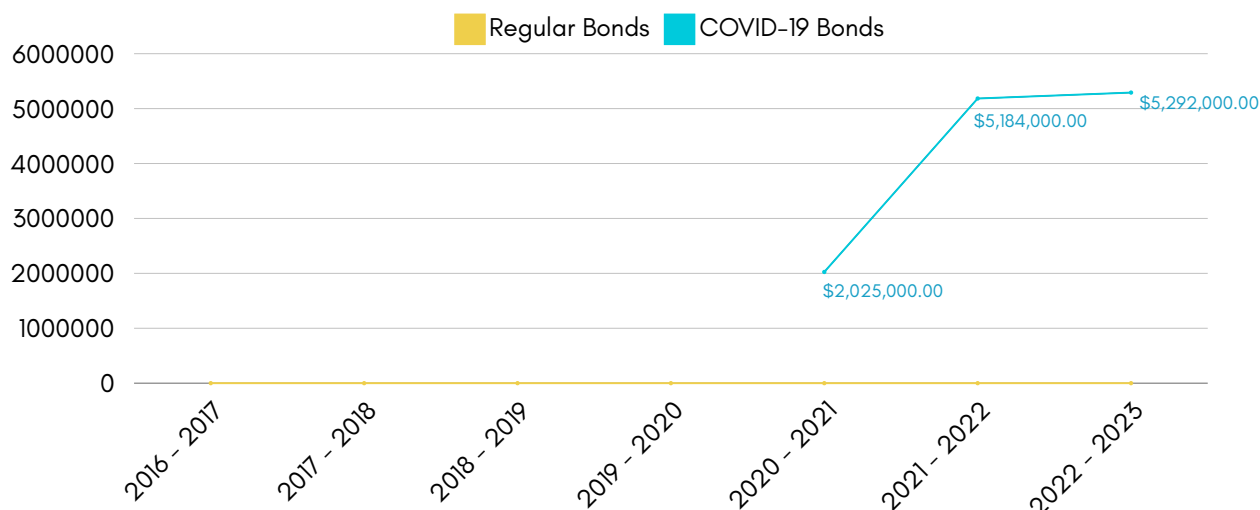
National Action Bond

The National Action Bond (NAB) was officially launched on 1 January 2023, replacing the temporary COVID-19 Bond Relief Option and originally instituted Government Bond Option. This new bond option is non-interest bearing, is held in the name of the citizen, and must be maintained for a minimum of five (5) years. Despite its availability, there were no applications received for the NAB investment option during the reporting period.

Government Bonds: Cash Inflows



Government Bonds: Administrative Fee



Investment Contribution for the Reporting Fiscal Period

2022 - 2023

1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023



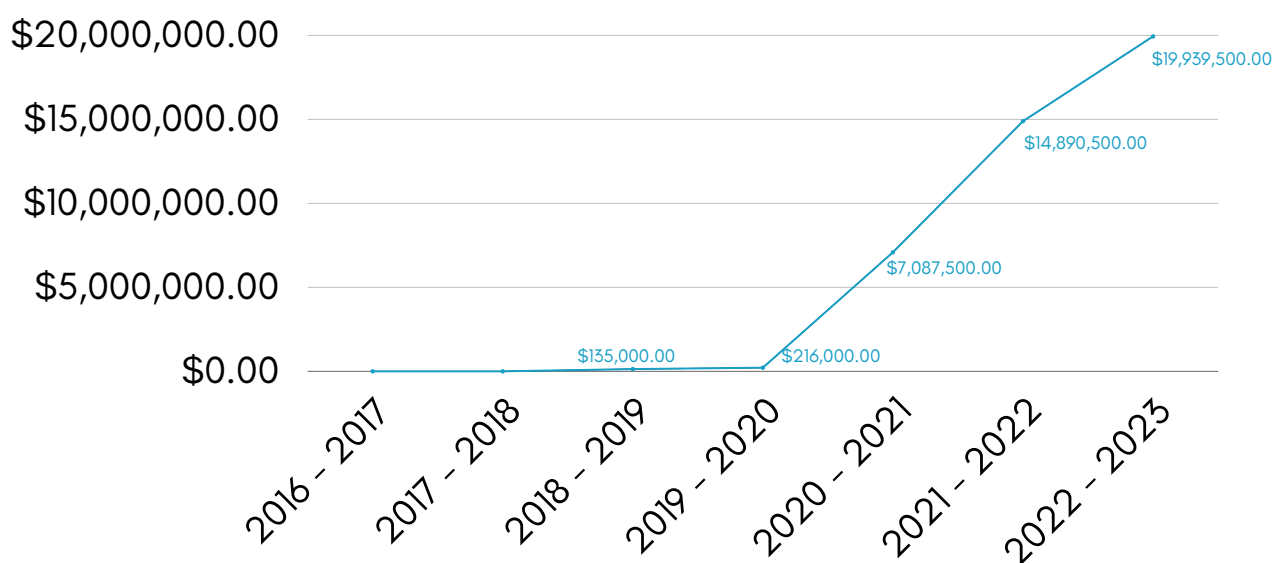
REAL ESTATE PROJECT

The Citizenship by Investment Board approved a real estate project for the grant of citizenship in Saint Lucia and was open for investment in 2018. The Saint Lucia Canelles Resort is being developed by Caribbean Galaxy Real Estate Ltd and managed by AMResorts, a subsidiary of Apple Leisure Group.

The below line graph depicts the administrative fees paid by an approved applicant for this investment option. The legislated investment amounts of US \$300,000 which was amended to US\$200,000 as of 31 December 2022 are made directly to the developer via an Escrow Account to which the Citizenship by Investment Unit has oversight.

Inflows for Real Estate Investment Amounts to US \$52,842,000 deposited into escrow for the period 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023. The graph below depicts the Administrative Fee paid by an approved applicant which is retained by the Citizenship by Investment Unit to maintain its operations.

Real Estate Project: Administrative Fee



Investment Contribution for the Reporting Fiscal Period

2022 - 2023

1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023



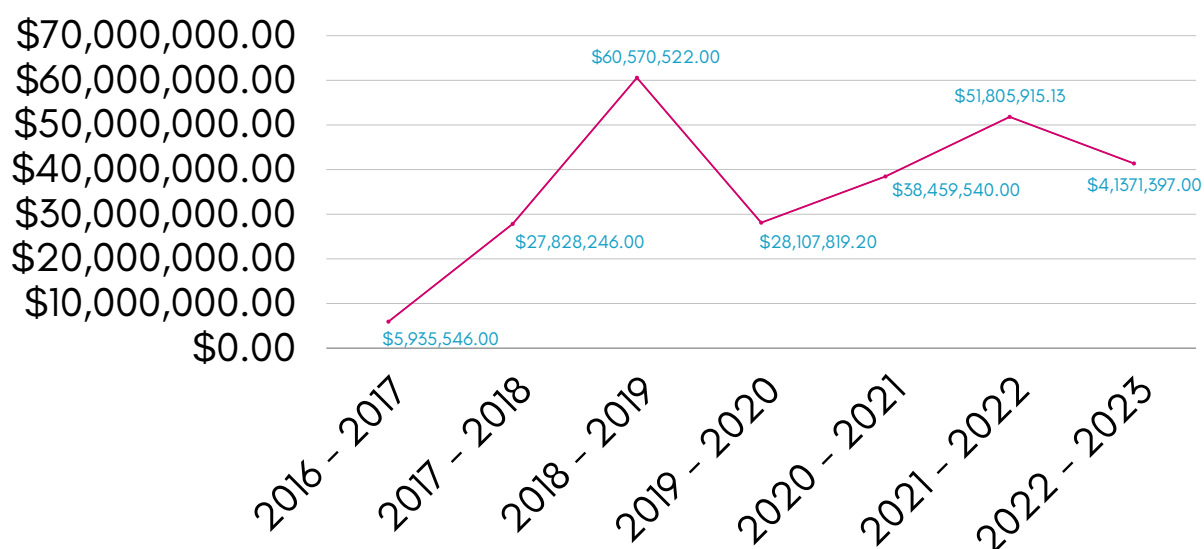
NATIONAL ECONOMIC FUND

The National Economic Fund (NEF) also known as the Donation Option is governed by the Saint Lucia National Economic Fund Act 18 of 2019. Eighty-percent (80%) of the funds are remitted to the Economic Fund and managed by a Board constituting of no less than five members and no more than seven members to be appointed by Cabinet as follows:

- (a) the Director of Finance who is the Chairperson;
- (b) the Budget Director;
- (c) the Chief Economist;
- (d) a representative from Invest Saint Lucia;
- (e) a representative from the Ministry responsible for Commerce;
- (f) a representative from the Attorney General's Chambers;
- (g) a representative from the private sector.

The remaining twenty-percent (20%) of funds are retained by the Citizenship by Investment Unit for the purpose of the program's global marketing thrust.

NEF: Investment Inflows



CIP Saint Lucia

Alien Landholding License Department Property Acquisition



Alien Landholding - Property Acquisition

Functions of the Alien Landholding Licensing Department

Since the enactment of the Alien Landholding ("Licensing") Act No. 1 of 2020 ("the Act"), the Alien Landholding Licensing Department ("the department"), established by the Citizenship by Investment Unit (Unit), has been responsible for issuing alien landholding licences (ALHL) to non-nationals acquiring property in St. Lucia.

The Act sought to enhance St. Lucia's investment appeal by streamlining the licensing process necessary to acquire real estate and by applying international due diligence and compliance standards under the Unit's oversight.



The Department's primary function is a two-phase licensing process:

Certificate of Eligibility (COE) – the application is a due diligence exercise on the applicant ('alien' under the Act), who may be a natural person, trustee, partnership, or company with 50% or more non-national control/ownership. Options include 1-year or 10-year certificates, granting the right to apply for licences during the validity of the certificate.

Alien Landholding Licence (ALHL) – the application allows non-nationals to acquire, lease, or hold property. Licences are non-transferrable and expire only upon full property disposal. Additionally, COE and ALHL holders can apply for an alien investor entrance permit, allowing them to stay in St. Lucia while holding a licence. This process involves requesting a support letter from the Unit and submitting it with the application to the Immigration Department. The dependants of beneficial owners and directors or partners of alien entities are also eligible to apply for alien investor entrance permits.

CHALLENGES

In early 2022, the Department faced inter-agency challenges that significantly affected our operations and efficiency. A major issue encountered was the delayed response times from other key government agencies to requests that are mandatory under the Act. This delay impeded the ability to process applications promptly and accurately within given estimated application timelines. As there was some initial confusion regarding the specific requirements from the various government agencies.

PROACTIVE MEASURES AND SUCCESSES

Despite facing various challenges, our department achieved significant successes in the 2022/2023 fiscal year through effective communication and strategic planning. We successfully clarified roles and responsibilities, ensuring that all involved agencies understood their scope under the Act.

Alien Landholding - Property Acquisition

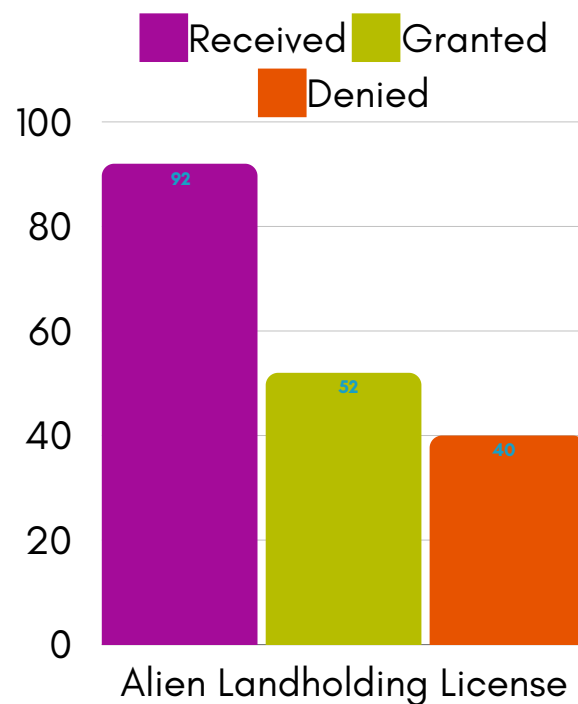
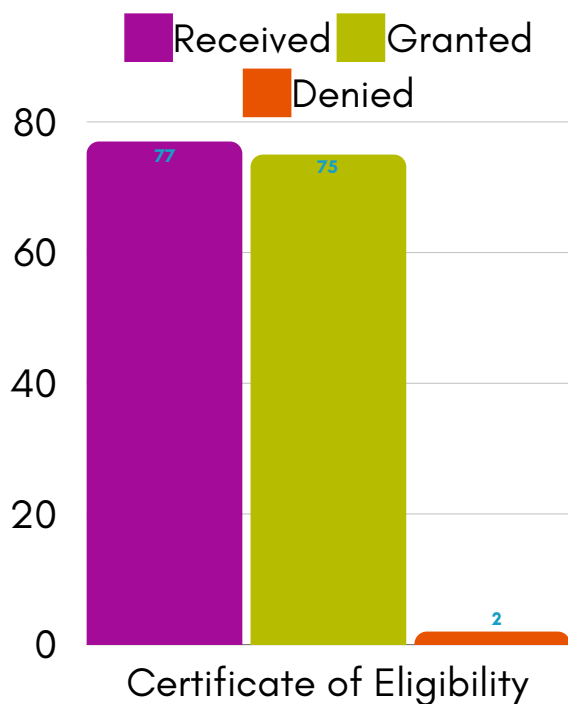
Functions of the Alien Landholding Licensing Department

By gaining a thorough understanding of the constraints and processes of the government agency, we were able to establish realistic timelines and implement direct communication channels, ultimately enhancing efficiency and responsiveness. This approach not only streamlined operations and improved transparency but also increased stakeholder satisfaction, showcasing our dedication to overcoming inter-agency challenges and enhancing overall efficiency.

ALHL STATISTICS: 2022/2023

During the reporting period of 2022/2023, a total of 169 applications were received. Specifically, there were 77 applications for Certificates of Eligibility (COE) and 92 applications for Alien Landholding Licenses (ALHL). Out of these, 75 COE applications were approved, while 2 were denied. Additionally, 52 ALHL applications were granted, with 40 being denied.

It is evident that there was a significant interest in obtaining such by an approximate increase of 217% from the previous reporting period.



CIP Saint Lucia

Financial Results

Fiscal Period: 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2023



Financial Results

Year ended 2022/2023

OVERVIEW

With the resumption of normal business activity globally since Covid 19, the investment migration landscape continues to show positive results from various source markets with St. Lucia's Citizenship by Investment Programme recording another year of phenomenal performance. Applications received for the period grew significantly compared to the prior year with considerable traction in the real estate option.



Performance overall realized a surplus of \$22,827,820 versus \$27,734,390 in the prior year albeit below by 18% but achieving better performance in revenue by 12%.

Overall gross revenue earned is \$60,631,316 compared to the prior year at \$54,169,344 reflecting an increase of 12%.

Programme Costs which are the key drivers of the programme are at \$33,777,687 resulting in an increase of 43% over the prior year or \$10,148,495.

Total operating expenses are at \$4,014,380 whilst the prior year was at \$2,791,871, reflecting a 44% increase.



Financial Results

Year ended 2022/2023

REVENUE

Total revenue from ordinary activities generated \$60,631,316 with an increase of 12% in contrast to the prior year of which administrative fees and due diligence fees contributed 42% and 33%, respectively.



Revenue 2022/2023				
Revenue Categories	March 2023	March 2022	Variance 2022/2023 Vs 2021/2022	% Change 2022/2023 versus 2021/2022
	\$('000)	\$('000)	\$('000)	%
20% Marketing & Promotions from Donations	11,999,340	13,113,630	(1,114,290)	-8%
Processing Fees	1,437,843	1,828,440	(390,597)	-21%
Due Diligence Fees	19,730,673	17,097,750	2,632,923	15%
Administrative Fees	25,231,500	20,074,500	5,157,000	26%
Authorizing Agents - Application Fees	8,100	8,100	0.00	0%
Authorizing Agents - Licence Fees	447,087	491,073	(43,986)	-9%
Promoter - Application Fees	31,552	5,400	26,152	484%
Promoter - Licence Fee	505,597	569,356	(63,759)	-11%
Marketing Agents - Licence Fees	246,233	168,880	77,354	46%
Alien Landholding - Application Fees	687,690	542,700	144,990	27%
Other Income	305,700	269,515	36,185	13%
	60,631,316	54,169,344	6,461,972	12%

Financial Results

Year ended 2022/2023

PROGRAMME COST

Programme costs for the period stood at \$33,777,686 and exceeded the prior year by 43% or \$10,148,494 as illustrated below.

Cost was significantly impacted by commissions paid to marketing agents, authorized/promoter agents and due diligence expenses incurred from service providers.



Programme Costs 2022/2023				
Programme Costs	March 2023	March 2022	Variance 2022/2023 Vs 2021/2022	% Change 2022/2023 versus 2021/2022
	\$('000)	\$('000)	\$('000)	%
Authorized Agents /Promoters Commissions	10,555,616	10,959,689	(404,074)	-4%
Marketing Agents' Commission	7,239,544	690,863	6,548,681	948%
Due Diligence Expense	14,630,097	10,787,136	3,842,961	36%
Marketing & Investor Relations	116,800	42,994	73,686	171%
Marketing & Promotions	116,587	983,330	(866,743)	-88%
Business Travel Overseas	1,119,162	165,180	953,982	578%
	33,777,686	23,639,192	10,148,494	43%

Financial Results

Year ended 2022/2023

OPERATING EXPENSE

Overall, operating expenses though prudently managed, exceeded the prior year by 44% due to the following contributing factors as illustrated in the table below.

- Payroll costs: increase in staffing due to the increasing volume of applications.
- Depreciation: increase in property, plant and equipment to facilitate staff increase and acquisition of a motor vehicle.
- Communication & IT: subscription for software licenses increased due to increase in staffing.
- Legal fees: cost incurred for legal representation.
- Insurance: Additional premium due to purchase of motor vehicle.
- Corporate sponsorship: sponsorship towards the Tourism Gimies.
- Bank charges: imposition of bank maintenance fees for processing CIP monetary transactions.



Operating Expenses 2022/2023				
Operating Expenses	March 2023	March 2022	Variance 2022/2023 Vs 2021/2022	% Change 2022/2023 versus 2021/2022
	\$('000)	\$('000)	\$('000)	%
Payroll Costs	2,312,799	1,874,507	438,292	23%
Depreciation & Amortization	234,158	179,402	54,756	31%
Office Rental	20,726	24,142	(3,416)	-14%
Communication & IT	198,982	159,694	39,288	25%
Board Remuneration	114,800	123,540	(8,748)	-7%
Audit Fees	40,500	34,712	5,788	17%
Consultancy	40,631	53,568	(12,937)	-24%
Legal Fees	95,125	0.00	95,125	100%
Insurance	16,612	8,431	8,181	97%
Office Supplies & Services	149,782	160,859	(11,077)	7%
Utilities	121,491	66,810	54,681	82%
Corporate Sponsorship	114,300	500.00	113,800	22,760%
Bank Charges	478,206	8,582	469,624	5,472%
Credit Card Commission	30,254	84,900	(54,646)	-64%
Foreign Exchange Loss	46,014	12,219	33,795	277%
	4,014,380	2,791,874	1,222,506	44%

Financial Results

Year ended 2022/2023

BALANCE SHEET

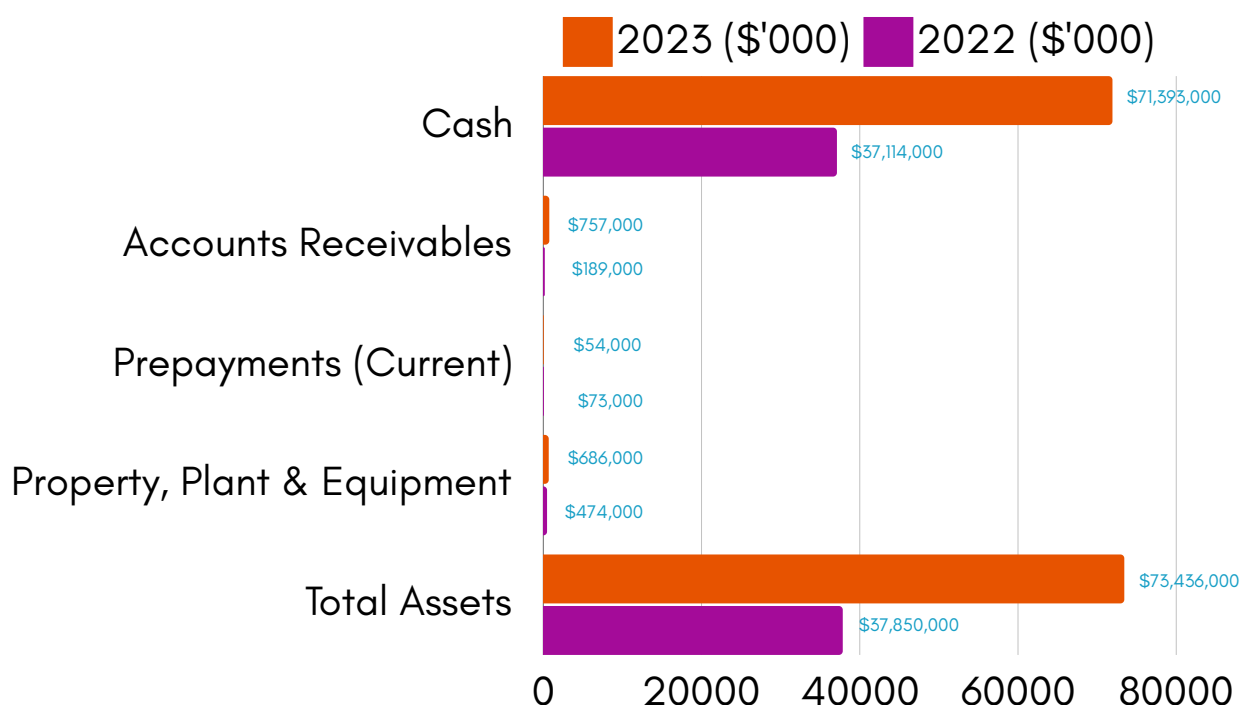
Total assets increased by \$35,584,500 or 94% in comparison to the prior year 2022. This is attributed to the significant growth in cash by \$34,825,397 due to the phenomenal performance in revenue from real estate investments and the increase in applications. The Unit has been in a strong position of liquidity and foresees no cash challenges.

Total current liabilities increased by \$24,182,816 or 214% in comparison to the fiscal year 2021/2022. This is driven by accrued due diligence charges to service providers and commissions payable to marketers, authorized agents and promoters stemming from the significant increase in applications for the period.

The Working Capital Ratio is at 2.05 for the period ended compared to 3.31 for the prior year 2021/2022.

With a net surplus of \$22,827,820 million in this period, Shareholders' equity grew to \$37,725,885 million or 44% versus prior year ended March 2022 despite excess cash of \$11,268,541 distributed to government in the period.

BALANCE SHEET FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS (ASSETS)



Financial Results

Year ended 2022/2023

BALANCE SHEET FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS (ASSETS)

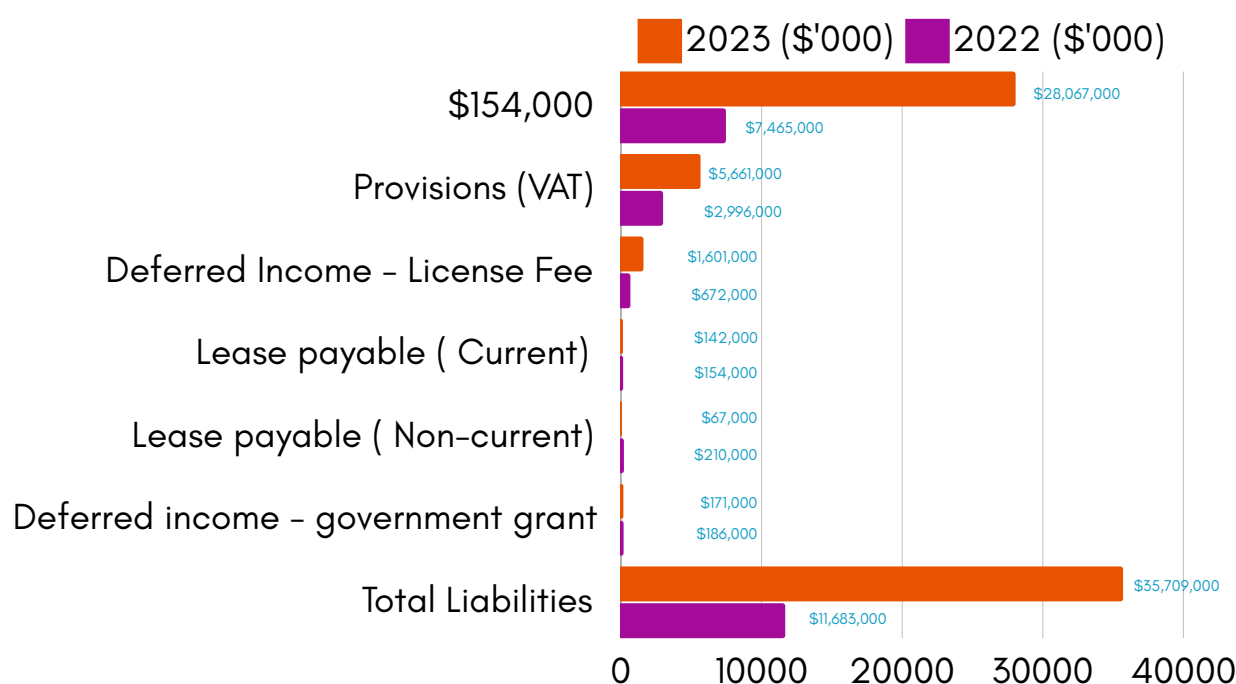
Significant movement in assets explained:

	Increase/ (Decrease) \$'000	Explanation
Cash	34,826	Net Cash generated from operations 46,694 Capital Expenditure (445) Movement in Lease liability - net (154) Government Distribution (11,269) Net Increase in Cash \$34,826k
Accounts receivables and prepayments	548	The increase is due diligence fees pending bank clearances.
Property, Plant & Equipment	211	The increase is accounted as follows: Additions 445 Depreciation (234) Net Increase \$211k

Financial Results

Year ended 2022/2023

BALANCE SHEET FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS (LIABILITIES)



	Increase/ (Decrease) \$'000	Explanation
Trade Payables and Accruals	20,602	The increase is due mainly to amounts owed to the National Economic Fund, Covid-19 Bonds payable to the Government of Saint Lucia and due diligence fees accrued for service providers along with commissions payable to marketers, authorised agents and promoters.
Lease Payables - (Current & Non-current)	(154)	The decrease is driven by the amortization of the office lease during the period of three-year term thus impacting the lease liability in accordance with IFRS 16.

CIP Saint Lucia

Audited Financial Statements

March 31, 2023

(expressed in Eastern Caribbean Dollars)





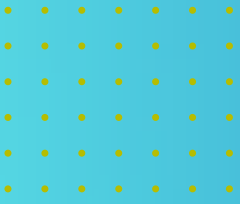
Notes

Annual Report 2022-2023



Notes

Annual Report 2022-2023



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